

The Terrifier of All Maras

Sarvamārabhayaṅkara · Toh 797 · Derge Kangyur

འཕགས་པ་བདད་ཐམས་ཅད་སྒྲུ་པར་བརྟེན་པ་ཞེས་བརྒྱ།

The Noble Dhāraṇī "The Terrifier of All Maras" (Tibetan: Phags pa bdud thams cad skrag par byed pa) is a short dhāraṇī text, a brief invocation built around a mantra, whose Sanskrit title appears to be Āryasarvamāratrāsana-nāma-dhāraṇī, though that reconstruction should be treated as tentative. It opens with homage to the Blessed One, Śākyamuni, and then gives the mantra itself, which draws on the imagery of jewels, blazing light, and the womb of the dharma-realm. The text then describes the effects of reciting it: virtuous gods are delighted and offer protection, while hostile forces, the maras, tremble and lose consciousness, and arrogant, unruly beings are struck with fear. It is Toh 797 in the Kangyur, where it belongs to the Tantra section as one of the many dhāraṇīs and protective mantras preserved there.

It is complete. The noble dhāraṇī called "The Terrifier of All Maras."

Homage to the Blessed One, Śākyamuni.

Oṃ sarva tathāgata maṇi śata dīpti. Jvala jvala. Dharma-dhātu-garbhe. Maṇi maṇi mahā-maṇi. Hṛdaya maṇi svāhā.

By reciting this mantra, the gods on the side of the white, the virtuous, are delighted and offer their protection. All the black maras tremble and fall unconscious. Arrogant and unruly beings are seized with terror, and

Translator's Notes

- The passage breaks off mid-sentence, so the translation ends where the Tibetan ends. The opening "It is complete" is the colophon-style closing of the preceding text, and the title of this new text follows immediately after it. The title is rendered as "The Terrifier of All Maras" (literally, "the one who makes all maras afraid"). The Sanskrit mantra is reconstructed from Tibetan transliteration, and the spelling "Śākyamuni" for the Tibetan "Śākya Thubba" follows house practice. In the mantra, "śata dīpti" is a tentative reconstruction, as the Tibetan "śa ta da pti" is probably corrupt; it could instead be read as "śata-dyuti" or similar, and the mantra itself is not translated, as is customary. "The white side" and "black maras" reflect the traditional contrast between the forces of virtue and the forces of obstruction. The word "dregs pa ma rungs pa" is rendered "arrogant and unruly beings," referring to haughty, harmful spirits.

Colophon

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Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.